

Chapter 153-5

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Xu Qingzhu received a phone call from Sheng Linlang, and since it was too noisy inside, Liang Shi accompanied her outside to take the call.

Sheng Linlang was also someone who rarely called her. This time she was calling to ask if she had returned, saying it had been a long time since they'd seen each other. She wanted to invite Su Yao and the others to come to her house tomorrow so they could all get together.

Xu Qingzhu agreed.

Afterward, the two exchanged pleasantries for a while before hanging up.

The wind was strong outside, and Xu Qingzhu's nose had turned red from the cold.

Liang Shi was no better off.

After hanging up, Liang Shi asked her what time it was.

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her phone: "Half past eight."

It was actually 20:32.

Liang Shi complained: "Who knows when Old Master Qin will show up."

Xu Qingzhu moved closer to her, the two standing close together to ward off the cold wind. "Actually, we could leave now."

"Never mind." Liang Shi pulled her back inside. "I shouldn't hold Teacher Xu back."

Xu Qingzhu was amused by her. "What's that supposed to mean?"

"Small things accumulate into big things." Liang Shi said as they walked back together. "We should always let President Xu maintain a good reputation."

"So now I'm President Xu again." Xu Qingzhu glanced at her. "How many more nicknames can you come up with for me?"

"I don't know." Liang Shi said, "That depends on how many professions you have."

Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue and was about to say something when she saw Liang Shi's expression change slightly. She turned her head and saw Qin Lishuang.

Qin Lishuang was standing at the spot where they had been sitting earlier, swirling a glass of wine in her hand, looking quite charming.

On Qin Lishuang's turf, Liang Shi didn't want to confront her head-on, so she pulled Xu Qingzhu intending to leave. But Qin Lishuang said: "Little Ah Shi, since we've already met, won't you bring your wife over for a drink?"

Qin Lishuang was quite brazen.

Liang Shi frowned: "No need."

"Just one glass." Qin Lishuang smiled lightly. "What's wrong with the younger generation these days? Don't they know how to respect their elders?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Qin Lishuang kept talking, clearly implying she wouldn't let them leave unless they drank. Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu's brows furrowed slightly. She stepped forward and looked at Qin Lishuang: "Miss Qin, my Ah Shi can't hold her liquor well. I'll drink this glass for her."

Xu Qingzhu looked at her, but instead of taking her own wine from the table, she asked a passing server for a glass, then walked up to clink glasses with Qin Lishuang.

Qin Lishuang's expression changed slightly, but she said nothing.

One glass of wine was drained.

Xu Qingzhu set the wine glass on the table. "Miss Qin, we have other matters to attend to. We'll take our leave first."

Qin Lishuang made a sound of acknowledgment and mentioned: "The starry ceiling over there is quite nice. Suitable for you lovebirds to look at."

With that, she left.

Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu didn't want to see her again, so they went over.

Liang Shi absolutely didn't dare let Xu Qingzhu get close to the pool area. Xu Qingzhu just laughed at her: "I can swim, you know."

Liang Shi shook her head: "That still won't do."

She was trying to change this major event.

They had only been standing there for less than two minutes when Sun Chengcheng walked over. "What a coincidence, Qingzhu. Didn't expect to run into you here."

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Mm."

Liang Shi stood to the side and said quite haughtily: "You didn't see me? Don't you think that's a coincidence?"

"It is quite a coincidence." Sun Chengcheng said awkwardly.

But just as those words fell, another voice came: "It really is quite a coincidence."

Turning around, they found it was Gu Yixue.

The three people from the production crew had gathered here, momentarily at a loss for what to say.

Liang Shi greeted Gu Yixue, while Xu Qingzhu's phone rang and she went aside to answer it.

20:41.

The time when Xu Qingzhu was supposed to fall into the water had already passed. Sun Chengcheng was secretly anxious inside.

Could it be that this event didn't have to happen?

Then wouldn't she miss her chance to see Lu Jiayi?

But then, just as Xu Qingzhu had walked only a few steps away, someone by the poolside cried out: "Ouch..."

A little girl had fallen down.

Xu Qingzhu rushed over when she saw it, but before she could help the little girl up, her own body went limp and she fell backward.

Splash.

"Big sister!" The little girl who had fallen tried to grab her, but couldn't hold on.

Even while talking to Gu Yixue, Liang Shi had been constantly watching Xu Qingzhu's movements. When she saw her fall into the water, she immediately ran over.

But in that instant, her body felt as heavy as a thousand pounds, unable to run.

By the time she jumped into the water, another splash had already sounded.

To her, it felt like slow-motion replay, but in reality, everything happened in the blink of an eye.

Liang Shi was also very fast, but the moment Xu Qingzhu fell into the water, a figure in white followed immediately after, jumping directly into the water to save Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Shi entered the water right behind.

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This sequence of events was like dumplings being dropped into a pot one after another¹.

Liang Shi was an excellent swimmer, but when she saw Xu Qingzhu underwater, her blue gauze dress had spread out in the water like a blooming flower.

And that flower was being held in the arms of that white figure.

In the instant Liang Shi swam over, she saw the slightly terrified look in Xu Qingzhu's eyes.

Her movements suddenly stopped, and in that moment, she had the thought of just letting things take their course.

But not even two seconds later, another figure appeared underwater.

She didn't know if it was her imagination, but Liang Shi thought she saw Zhao Xuning.

Footnotes:

¹ Like dumplings being dropped into a pot (跟下饺子似的): A Chinese expression used to describe multiple people or things entering water in quick succession, likening it to the way dumplings are dropped one after another into boiling water when cooking.